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Rose

February 1945

Four months later, Rose awoke to darkness. In the past weeks, sleep came only in broken, restless fragments. The war was twisting toward its violent end, but for her, a new battle was about to begin.

In a woven basket on the floor, Katya stirred gently. Leaning over, Rose saw the baby's bright eyes shining in the gloom. She kissed her on the forehead, the skin cool against her lips, then cradled her on her chest and covered her with the blanket.

Katya was smaller than expected for five months, but Josef assured the sisters she was doing fine. To Rose, she was perfect. Katya hardly cried. Since they carried her everywhere in a sling at the front or back, she smiled at everyone. André claimed he'd never seen such a happy baby, and said it was the love of two mothers—Léa, who cared for her during the day in the sick bay, and Rose, who watched her at night and in the mornings.

She thought back to the night Nadiya had died. She and Léa had stayed up talking about how they would care for the newborn—with Reinhardt's money, they could pay a local wet nurse to feed Katya—and then about how they should keep Nadiya's memory alive for her daughter. "Imagine, one day the child might want to know who her real mother was, what she looked like, if there's a family photo or a name of a hometown," Léa had said. "All we have is her *Arbeitsbuch*."

The day after Nadiya's death, Rose walked up the stairs to the barracks where the Russian women lived, determined to find something among Nadiya's belongings that they could save for Katya. It was late afternoon, and the barracks were empty. Rose knew the Russian women worked longer